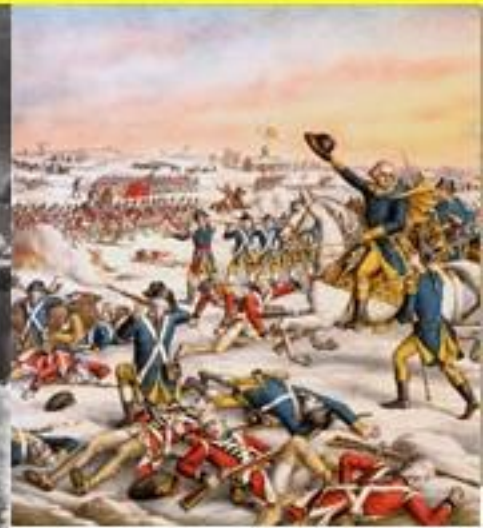


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 39

THE COLD WAR - 1

1 The end of the Second World War saw the rise of the U.S.A. and U.S.S.R. as Super Powers.

2 The strained relationship between these two countries till the collapse of the U.S.S.R is known as the Cold War.

3 The term 'Cold War' was used for the first time by Bernard Baruch. Thereafter this term gained popularity through the journalist Walter Lippman.



Bernard Baruch



Walter Lippman

4 The Cold War may be described as the existence of continued tensions and conflicts between the western world and the Communist countries in general and between the United States and the Soviet Union in particular.

5 The Cold War was otherwise an ideological war or a propaganda war or a diplomatic war.

6 It was neither a condition of war nor a condition of peace.

It was a state of uneasy peace.



1 BERLIN BLOCKADE

1 Even before the end of the Second World War the Soviet Union had imposed Communist regimes in the East European countries of Poland, Bulgaria, Rumania, Hungary and Yugoslavia.

2 Immediately after the War the Soviet Union brought East Germany under her influence.

3 West Germany came under the influence of the U.S.A.

4 The Soviet Union blocked all roads to the west-occupied zones in Berlin.

5 This is known as Berlin Blockade.

6 Thus, a tense situation developed between the two blocs of the Cold War groups.



2

MARSHALL PLAN

- 1** The West was now concerned about the Russian influence.
- 2** The U.S.A. had then assumed the responsibility of containing Communism.
- 3** On 5th June 1947, the Marshall Plan was announced by the U.S.A. by which economic assistance was to be provided to the western European nations.
- 4** It was a step to save the European Continent from the growing influence of Communism.



3 MOLOTOV PLAN

- In response to American Marshall Plan, the Soviet Union initiated Molotov Plan.

4 TRUMAN DOCTRINE

- On 12th March 1948, Truman Doctrine (Truman was the President of USA) was announced and accordingly the U.S.A. provided economic and military aid to Greece and Turkey to the tune of 400 million dollars in order to stop the Soviet influence in those countries.



NORTH ATLANTIC TREATY ORGANIZATION (NATO)

- 1** The U.S.A had created a military alliance to prevent further spread of communism into Western Europe.
- 2** A beginning in this direction was made by the signing of the Brussels Treaty in March 1948.
- 3** Britain, France, Holland, Belgium and Luxemburg signed this treaty promising military collaboration in case of war.
- 4** On 4th April 1949, the North Atlantic Treaty was signed thus forming a military power bloc, commonly known as the North Atlantic Treaty Organization or NATO.



NORTH ATLANTIC TREATY ORGANIZATION (NATO)

- 5** The U.S.A., Canada, Britain, France, Holland, Belgium and Luxemburg, Portugal, Denmark, Italy and Norway became its members.
- 6** They had agreed to mutually extend military help in case of an attack on any one of them.
- 7** It was formed against the Soviet Union.



- 1** Between 1955 and 1958, West Asia remained the centre of the Cold War.
- 2** In the series of western military pacts, the Baghdad Pact was concluded in 1955, later known as Central Treaty Organization (CENTO).
- 3** These alliances were generally unpopular in the countries of Asia and Africa as all the imperialist powers of Europe were members of these alliances and used it to suppress the movements for freedom.
- 4** Most of the countries of Asia and Africa which had won their freedom refused to join these alliances.



- 1** In response to these western military pacts, the Soviet Union concluded the Warsaw Pact on 14th May 1955 with her satellite powers.
- 2** As against these Western and Western sponsored alliances, the Soviet Union and the socialist countries of Europe —Poland, Czechoslovakia, Hungary, Rumania, Bulgaria and the German Democratic Republic formed the Warsaw Pact.
- 3** Under this pact, the Soviet Union stationed her troops in these countries. However, the Soviet Union and the other members of the Warsaw Pact did not have any military bases in other parts of the world.
- 4** The Soviet Union had treaties of friendship and mutual assistance with China.
- 5** During this phase a number of military pacts were concluded, but the tension between East and West was somewhat reduced.



1 The establishment of People's Republic of China by Mao-Tse Tung in October 1949 strengthened the Soviet bloc.

2 The U.S.A. refused to recognize the Communist Government of China.

3 On the other-hand, the U.S.A. helped Chiang Kai-Shek to establish his Nationalist Government in Taiwan.

4 The U.S.A. recognised the Nationalist Government as the legal Government of China and made her as a permanent member of the U.N. Security Council.

5 The Communist China or the People's Republic of China was prevented by the U.S.A. to become a member in the UNO.



- 1** In 1950, the arena of the cold war was changed from Europe to East Asia.
- 2** After the Second World War Korea was split into north and south Korea.
- 3** In the North Korea the Soviet – supported communist government was formed, while the South Korea had an American - sponsored government.
- 4** The two Korean governments were in conflict with each other.
- 5** On 25th June 1950 North Korea attacked South Korea.

- 6** North Korea was fighting with Soviet weapons and Chinese troops, while the U.S.A. in the name of U.N. force was fighting on behalf of South Korea.



- 1** Cold War was extended to Vietnam also.
- 2** The fall of Dien Bien Phu on 7th May 1954 brought the final collapse of France in Indo-China.
- 3** By Geneva Agreement, Vietnam was partitioned at the 17th parallel between North Vietnam and South Vietnam.
- 4** A conflict developed between North Vietnam and South Vietnam.
- 5** The U.S.A. entered the war supporting South Vietnam.



1 In order to contain Communism in South East Asia, the South East Asia Treaty Organization (SEATO) was formed in 1954.

2 In 1954 South East Asia Treaty Organization (SEATO) was signed on September 8, 1954 and established formally in Bangkok in 1955.

3 The prime objective was to stop communalism in South West Asia.

4 The members were Australia, France, New Zealand, Thailand, Pakistan, Philippines, United Kingdom, United States.

5 It was basically a Southeast Asian version of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO).

6 Pakistan withdrew from it in 1973 and the organization was dissolved in 1977.

7 India was neither interested in SEATO type of blocs and nor did it show any keenness in joining ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) at the time of its formation in 1967.



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To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

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